

Absolutely — **clean** is a strong polysemy target because it looks simple, but modern English uses it across **physical cleanliness, purity, neatness, legality, sport, technology/data, energy, design, morality, and adverbial emphasis**.

Word family: **clean / cleaner / cleanest / cleanly / cleanliness / clean-up / cleanup / cleaner**

Base word: clean

Comparative: cleaner

Superlative: cleanest

Adverb: cleanly

Noun: cleanliness

Related noun: cleaner

Useful compounds / extensions: clean energy, clean water, clean record, clean break, clean sweep, clean bill of health

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / verb (動詞) / adverb (副詞 , 部分固定用法) / noun-related forms (相關名詞)

1. **clean** = not dirty (表面 / 物件) — 乾淨的 ; 清潔的

The core literal meaning.

Practice 1

> “The kitchen is very **clean**.”

「廚房非常**乾淨**。」

Practice 2

> “Use a clean cloth to wipe the leaves.”

「用一塊**乾淨**的布**擦拭**葉子。」

clean = 沒有污垢、灰塵、污漬或其他髒東西的

2. **clean** = hygienic / free from harmful contamination (衛生) — 衛生的 ; 潔淨的

A closely related but more health-focused sense.

Practice 3

> “Make sure the drinking water is **clean**.”

「要確保飲用水是**潔淨 / 衛生的**。」

Practice 4

> “The tools must be kept clean.”

「工具必須保持**清潔衛生**。」

****clean = 沒有會造成污染、感染或健康問題的有害物質****

This is more than just “looks not dirty.”

3. ****clean = pure / not mixed with unwanted substances (純淨) — 純淨的 ; 沒有雜質的****

Practice 5

> “The laboratory needs a supply of ****clean air****.”

「實驗室需要供應**潔淨空氣**。」

Practice 6

> “The process produces cleaner water.”

「這個過程能產生**更潔淨的水**。」

****clean = 不含不需要的污染物、雜質或有害成分的****

4. ****clean = neat / orderly in appearance (外觀) — 整潔的 ; 俐落的****

A common extension.

Practice 7

> “The room has a ****clean, simple design****.”

「這個房間採用**整潔簡約的設計**。」

Practice 8

> “The document has a clean layout.”

「這份文件的版面非常**清晰整潔**。」

****clean = 視覺上整齊、簡潔、沒有多餘混亂元素的****

Common in:

- * design
- * typography
- * interiors
- * interfaces

5. ****clean = clear / precise / smooth (動作 / 結果) — 乾淨俐落的 ; 利落的****

Practice 9

> “The player made a ****clean catch****.”

「那名球員完成了一個****俐落、沒有失誤的接球****。」

Practice 10

> “The knife made a clean cut.”

「那把刀切出了一個****整齊俐落的切口****。」

****clean = 動作或結果準確、完整、沒有拖泥帶水或意外干擾的****

6. ****clean = legitimate / honest / not involved in crime (品行 / 法律) — 清白的 ; 沒有不良紀錄的****

Practice 11

> “He has a ****clean record****.”

「他有****清白 / 沒有不良紀錄的紀錄****。」

Practice 12

> “The investigation found the employee to be clean.”

「調查顯示那名員工****沒有涉及違法或不當行為****。」

****clean = 沒有犯罪、違規、作弊或可疑行為紀錄的****

7. ****clean = drug-free / free from banned substances (毒品 / 體育) — 沒有使用毒品 / 禁藥的****

Practice 13

> “The athlete tested ****clean****.”

「那名運動員的檢測結果顯示****沒有使用禁藥****。」

Practice 14

> “He has been clean for two years.”

「他已經兩年****沒有使用毒品****。」

****clean = 沒有使用毒品、酒精或被禁止物質的****

Context matters greatly.

8. ****clean = fair / according to the rules (體育) — 公平的；沒有犯規的****

Practice 15

> “It was a ****clean tackle****.”

「那是一個****沒有犯規的攔截****。」

Practice 16

> “The match was hard but clean.”

「比賽很激烈，但整體上****公平、沒有骯髒犯規動作****。」

****clean — sport = 沒有作弊、犯規或不正當手段的****

9. ****clean = morally decent / not offensive (內容) — 健康的；不粗俗的****

Practice 17

> “The comedian kept the jokes **clean**.”

「那位喜劇演員把笑話保持得**健康、不粗俗**。」

Practice 18

> “It’s a clean family show.”

「這是一個適合家庭觀看、內容**健康的節目**。」

clean = 不含色情、粗俗、猥褻或冒犯性內容的

10. **clean** = environmentally less harmful (能源 / 科技) — 清潔的；環保的

A major modern meaning.

Practice 19

> “The country is investing in **clean energy**.”

「該國正投資**清潔能源**。」

Practice 20

> “Clean technology can reduce pollution.”

「**清潔科技**可以減少污染。」

clean — environmental = 產生較少污染、碳排放或其他環境傷害的

Common:

* clean energy

* clean technology

* clean fuel

11. **clean** = free from unwanted data/code/noise (科技 / 資料) — 乾淨的；無錯誤 / 無雜訊的

A useful technical extension.

Practice 21

> “We need a **clean dataset** before analysis.”

「分析前我們需要一份**乾淨、沒有明顯錯誤的資料集**。」

Practice 22

> “The recording has a very clean sound.”

「這段錄音的聲音非常**清晰、沒有雜訊**。」

clean = 沒有雜訊、錯誤、污染資料或多餘內容的

12. **clean** = blank / unused / fresh (表面 / 檔案) — 空白的；未使用的

Practice 23

> “Start with a **clean sheet of paper**.”

「先拿一張**空白乾淨的紙**。」

Practice 24

> “Open a clean document and copy the text into it.”

「開一份**新的空白文件**，把文字複製進去。」

clean = 尚未寫上、修改或加入其他內容的

13. **clean** = complete / absolute (強調) — 完全的；徹底的

This appears in some fixed combinations.

Practice 25

> “They made a **clean break** with the past.”

「他們與過去作了**徹底的切割**。」

Practice 26

> “The team achieved a clean sweep.”

「該隊取得了**全勝 / 包辦所有勝利**。」

clean = 完整、徹底、不留殘餘或例外的

This is mainly in fixed expressions.

14. **clean = verb, remove dirt — 清潔；弄乾淨**

Now **clean** is a verb.

Practice 27

> “She **cleaned** the kitchen.”

「她**清潔了**廚房。」

Practice 28

> “Clean the tools after using them.”

「使用後要把工具**清潔乾淨**。」

clean = 去除污垢、灰塵、污漬等，使某物變乾淨

15. **clean = remove unwanted material (整理 / 處理) — 清理；去除**

Practice 29

> “We need to **clean** the data before analysis.”

「分析前我們需要**清理資料**。」

Practice 30

> “She cleaned the fish before cooking it.”

「她煮魚前先把魚**處理乾淨 / 清理好**。」

clean = 去除不需要、不能使用或會造成問題的部分

This broadens beyond literal dirt.

16. **clean = empty completely (口語) — 清空 ; 拿光**

Usually in expressions like **clean out**; since we normally avoid phrasal verbs, I'll just flag it.

> “The thieves cleaned out the shop.”

= 賊人把店內財物**搜掠一空**。

This is useful, but best kept as a phrasal-verb extension rather than a core sense of bare **clean**.

17. **cleanly = in a clean/neat way (動作) — 乾淨俐落地**

Practice 31

> “The branch broke **cleanly**.”

「樹枝**乾脆俐落地**折斷了。」

Practice 32

> “The knife cut cleanly through the fruit.”

「刀子**俐落地**切過水果。」

cleanly = 動作整齊、完整、沒有拖拉或破碎地完成

18. **cleanly = hygienically (衛生) — 衛生地 ; 乾淨地**

Practice 33

> “The food must be prepared **cleanly**.”

「食物必須以**衛生的方式**處理。」

Practice 34

> “The wound was cleanly dressed.”

「傷口被**妥善而清潔地**包紮。」

****cleanly = 以乾淨、衛生的方式****

19. ****cleanliness = state of being clean — 清潔；潔淨程度****

Practice 35

> “The hotel is known for its ****cleanliness****.”

「這間酒店以****清潔衛生****聞名。」

Practice 36

> “Kitchen cleanliness is essential.”

「廚房的****清潔衛生****非常重要。」

****cleanliness = 沒有污垢、污染並維持衛生整潔的狀態****

20. ****cleaner = person who cleans — 清潔工；清潔人員****

Practice 37

> “The ****cleaner**** comes every Friday.”

「****清潔工****每星期五都會來。」

Practice 38

> “The office employs two cleaners.”

「辦公室聘用了兩名****清潔人員****。」

****cleaner = 負責清潔建築物、房間等的人****

21. ****cleaner = substance/device used for cleaning — 清潔劑；清潔器****

Practice 39

> “Use a glass **cleaner** on the window.”

「用玻璃**清潔劑**清潔窗戶。」

Practice 40

> “This steam cleaner works well on floors.”

「這部蒸氣**清潔機**清潔地板效果很好。」

cleaner = 用來清潔某物的化學產品、工具或設備

22. **clean-up / cleanup** = act of cleaning/removing mess — 清理；清潔工作

Practice 41

> “The **cleanup** took several hours.”

「**清理工作**花了幾個小時。」

Practice 42

> “Volunteers joined the beach clean-up.”

「義工參加了海灘**清潔行動**。」

cleanup / clean-up = 把垃圾、污物或混亂清除掉的活動 / 過程

Spelling depends on function/style:

* **cleanup** noun/adjective especially AmE

* **clean-up** also common

* **clean up** verb

23. **clean record** (紀錄) — 清白紀錄；沒有違規紀錄

Practice 43

> “She has a **clean driving record**.”

「她有良好的**無違規駕駛紀錄**。」

Practice 44

> “The candidate had a clean disciplinary record.”

「該候選人有**清白的紀律紀錄**。」

clean record = 沒有犯罪、違規、處分或其他負面紀錄的紀錄

24. **clean bill of health (健康 / 比喻) — 健康證明；確認沒有問題**

A very useful idiom.

Practice 45

> “The doctor gave him a **clean bill of health**.”

「醫生確認他**健康狀況良好，沒有發現問題**。」

Practice 46

> “The inspection gave the system a clean bill of health.”

「檢查結果確認該系統**沒有重大問題**。」

a clean bill of health = 經檢查後確認健康 / 狀況良好、沒有重大問題

Can be literal or figurative.

25. **clean break (關係 / 改變) — 徹底切割；乾脆結束**

Practice 47

> “She wanted a **clean break** from her old job.”

「她想和舊工作**徹底告別**。」

Practice 48

> “The company made a clean break with the old system.”

「公司與舊制度作出**徹底切割**。」

****clean break = 清楚、完整地結束一段關係、制度或過往狀況，不留下拖延****

26. ****clean sweep (全面勝出 / 徹底清除) — 全勝；包辦所有項目****

Practice 49

> “The team made a ****clean sweep**** of the awards.”

「該隊****包辦了所有獎項****。」

Practice 50

> “The party achieved a clean sweep in the local contests.”

「該黨在當地各項競賽中****全數勝出****。」

****clean sweep = 在一系列比賽、獎項或競爭中全部取勝 / 拿下所有項目****

27. ****clean slate (重新開始) — 一筆勾銷；重新開始****

A very common figurative expression.

Practice 51

> “They decided to start with a ****clean slate****.”

「他們決定****重新開始，把過去一筆勾銷****。」

Practice 52

> “The new manager wanted a clean slate.”

「新經理希望可以****從頭開始****。」

****clean slate = 不受過去錯誤、債務或問題影響，重新開始的狀態****

28. ****clean-cut (外表 / 風格) — 整潔俐落的；外表端正的****

Practice 53

> “He has a **clean-cut** appearance.”

「他的外表**整潔俐落、端正**。」

Practice 54

> “The design is simple and clean-cut.”

「這個設計簡單而**線條俐落**。」

clean-cut = 外表或線條整齊、端正、界線清楚的

29. **clean-shaven** (外貌) — 刮淨鬍子的

Practice 55

> “He was **clean-shaven**.”

「他**把鬍子刮得很乾淨 / 沒有留鬍子**。」

Practice 56

> “The photo shows him clean-shaven.”

「照片中的他**沒有留鬍子**。」

clean-shaven = 臉上鬍鬚已全部剃掉的

Important distinction: **clean** vs **clear**

clean

= free from dirt/contamination/unwanted material.

clear

= easy to see through/understand; unobstructed.

> clean water

> = 沒有污染的水

> clear water
> = 透明清澈的水

Water can be visually **clear** but still not be microbiologically **clean/safe**.

Important distinction: **clean** vs **tidy**

clean

= not dirty.

tidy

= arranged neatly.

A room can be:

- * clean but untidy;
- * tidy but dirty.

So:

> clean = 乾淨
> tidy = 整齊

Important distinction: **clean** vs **pure**

clean

= free from dirt, contamination, or unwanted material.

pure

= consisting only of the intended substance, not mixed.

> clean water
> = 潔淨水

> pure water
> = 高純度 / 純水

Pure is stricter in scientific contexts.

Important distinction: **clean vs hygienic**

clean

may refer to visible cleanliness.

hygienic

specifically means practices/conditions that protect health and prevent infection.

A surface may look **clean** but still not be fully **hygienic**.

Important distinction: **clean vs neat**

clean

can mean visually uncluttered.

neat

means orderly and carefully arranged.

In design:

> clean design

> = 簡潔、沒有多餘元素

> neat design

> = 整齊、安排得好

They overlap but are not identical.

Important distinction: **clean vs green**

You already curated **green**.

clean energy

= energy producing relatively little pollution/emissions.

green energy

= environmentally friendly energy.

They overlap heavily, but **clean** emphasizes low pollution/emissions, while **green** is broader environmental framing.

Important distinction: **clean vs safe**

clean

= free from dirt/contamination.

safe

= not dangerous.

Something can be clean but unsafe for another reason.

Important distinction: **clean record vs good record**

clean record

= no violations/problems.

good record

= positive performance/history.

A person may have a **clean record** simply because they have no offences, even if their performance is not exceptional.

Important distinction: **cleanly vs clean**

clean

usually adjective:

> “a clean cut”

cleanly

adverb:

> “The knife cut cleanly.”

But **clean** itself can also function adverbially in some informal/fixed uses:

> “The bullet went clean through the wall.”

Here **clean** means:

> **completely / right through**

This is worth flagging as a special adverbial use.

30. **clean = completely (副詞 , 固定用法) — 完全地 ; 徹底地**

Practice 57

> “The ball went **clean through** the window.”

「球**直接完全穿過**窗戶。」

Practice 58

> “I clean forgot about the meeting.”

「我把會議**完全忘記了**。」

clean — adverb, informal = completely / entirely

This is especially common in:

* clean through

* clean forgot

Register: informal, somewhat old-fashioned in some constructions.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **clean — not dirty** = 乾淨
* **clean — hygienic** = 衛生潔淨
* **clean — pure/uncontaminated** = 純淨 / 無污染
* **clean — visual/design** = 簡潔整齊
* **clean — precise/smooth** = 乾淨俐落
* **clean — legal/moral record** = 清白
* **clean — drug-free** = 沒有使用毒品 / 禁藥
* **clean — sport** = 公平、不犯規
* **clean — content** = 不粗俗 / 健康
* **clean — environmental** = 清潔環保
* **clean — data/audio** = 無雜訊 / 無錯誤
* **clean — blank/fresh** = 空白 / 未使用
* **clean — complete** = 徹底 / 完整
* **clean — verb** = 清潔
* **clean — remove unwanted material** = 清理
* **cleanly** = 乾淨俐落地 / 衛生地
* **cleanliness** = 清潔程度
* **cleaner — person** = 清潔人員
* **cleaner — product/device** = 清潔劑 / 清潔器
* **cleanup** = 清理工作
* **clean record** = 清白紀錄
* **clean bill of health** = 經確認沒有健康 / 系統問題
* **clean break** = 徹底切割
* **clean sweep** = 全勝 / 包辦所有項目
* **clean slate** = 重新開始
* **clean-cut** = 整潔俐落
* **clean-shaven** = 刮淨鬍子的
* **clean — adverb** = 完全地

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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clean — physical	沒有污垢、灰塵、污漬等髒東西的
clean — hygienic	沒有足以造成污染、感染或健康問題的有害物質
clean — pure/uncontaminated	不含不需要的污染物、雜質或有害成分的
clean — design	視覺上簡潔整齊、沒有多餘混亂元素的
clean — precise	動作 / 結果準確俐落、沒有失誤或拖泥帶水的
clean — record	沒有犯罪、違規、作弊或不當行為紀錄的
clean — drug-free	沒有使用毒品、禁藥或其他受禁物質的
clean — sport	沒有犯規、作弊或使用不正當手段的
clean — content	不含粗俗、猥褻或冒犯內容的

clean — environmental	產生較少污染、排放或環境傷害的	
clean — data/audio	沒有錯誤、雜訊、污染資料或多餘內容的	
clean — blank/fresh	尚未寫上、修改或加入其他內容的	
clean — complete	完整、徹底、不留殘餘或例外的	
clean — verb	去除污垢、灰塵等，使某物變乾淨	
clean — remove unwanted material	去除不需要、不能使用或有問題的部分	
cleanly	以整齊俐落、完整或衛生的方式	
cleanliness	沒有污垢、污染並保持衛生整潔的狀態	
cleaner — person	負責清潔建築物 / 房間的人	
cleaner — product/device	用來清潔的化學產品、工具或設備	
cleanup	清除垃圾、污物或混亂的活動 / 過程	
clean record	沒有犯罪、違規或處分的紀錄	
clean bill of health	經檢查後確認健康 / 狀況良好、沒有重大問題	
clean break	清楚而完整地結束過去關係 / 制度 / 狀況	
clean sweep	在一系列競賽或項目中全部取勝	
clean slate	不受過往問題影響，重新開始的狀態	
clean-cut	外表、線條或風格整潔俐落的	
clean-shaven	臉上鬍鬚全部剃掉的	
clean — adverb	完全地；徹底地，常見於固定 / 非正式用法	

Core learner contrasts

- > ****clean room**** → 乾淨的房間
- > ****clean water**** → 潔淨、沒有污染的水
- > ****clean design**** → 簡潔俐落的設計
- > ****clean record**** → 清白紀錄
- > ****clean athlete/test**** → 沒有使用禁藥
- > ****clean energy**** → 清潔能源
- > ****clean data**** → 沒有錯誤 / 污染的資料
- > ****clean break**** → 徹底切割
- > ****clean slate**** → 重新開始
- > ****clean vs tidy**** → 乾淨 vs 整齊
- > ****clean vs clear**** → 無污染 / 無污垢 vs 清晰 / 透明